KOCHI WATER METRO
Launched in April 2023

Achievement: Country's only fully green urban transport system



SMOOTH PASSAGE
An electric boat of the Kochi water metro plying between Vytilla and Kakkanad

Photographs by ASHISH K VINCENT

THE GREEN FERRY

A zero-pollution electric hybrid ferry service in the Kochi backwaters sets the bar high for future public transport systems

By JEEMON JACOB

THE DRUDGERY

Kochi, the commercial capital of Kerala and home to 3 million people, is also its most congested city, with vehicles crawling at 9-15 km per hour during peak traffic. It also has a swarm of islands dotting its neighbourhood, some of which, like Vypeen and Cherai, are among the most densely populated areas in the country. Thousands of people ply to the mainland and the interconnected islands everyday for work and pleasure, either by bus or using private vehicles, adding to the chaos on the narrow roads.